

AUSTRIA

Model UN Research Dossier – Austria

◆ Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Austria (Republik Österreich)
Short Form	Austria
Capital	Vienna
Region (UN)	Western European and Other States
Government Type	Federal parliamentary republic
Head of State	President Alexander Van der Bellen
Head of Government	Chancellor Karl Nehammer
Currency	Euro (EUR)
UN Member Since	14 December 1955
MUN Standing	Active participant in UN peacekeeping and human rights initiatives; member of various UN bodies; advocates for multilateralism and international law.

General Book Recommendations

1. **"Austria: Politics, Society and Economy"** – Peter Gerlich
2. **"The Austrian Nation: Cultural Consciousness and National Identity"** – Ernst Bruckmüller
3. **"Austria in the European Union"** – Günter Bischof, Anton Pelinka
4. **"Neutrality and State-Building in Austria"** – Rolf Steininger
5. **"The Politics of Austria"** – Kurt Richard Luther, Wolfgang C. Müller

Source Name	Link
Austria's Membership in the UNHRC	https://www.austria.org/austria-in-the-un-human-rights-council
Austria's Candidacy Pledges	https://www.bmeia.gv.at/fileadmin/user_upload/Zentrale/Aussenpolitik/Menschenrechte/Pledges_and_commitments_AT.pdf
OHCHR – Austria Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/austria
Membership of the Human Rights Council	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/hrc/membership

Austria's Human Rights Initiatives	https://www.austria.org/human-rights-and-the-council-of-europe
Austria's Human Rights Education Programs	https://www.bmeia.gv.at/en/european-foreign-policy/austria-and-the-united-nations
Austria's Efforts Against Human Trafficking	https://www.bmeia.gv.at/en/european-foreign-policy/austria-and-the-united-nations
Austria's Role in Promoting Rule of Law	https://www.bmeia.gv.at/en/european-foreign-policy/austria-and-the-united-nations

Unique Aspects:

1. **Human Rights Leadership:** Volker Türk from Austria holds the position of UN High Commissioner for Human Rights.
2. **Vienna Declaration:** The host of the 1993 World Conference on Human Rights, which led to the Vienna Declaration.
3. **Counter-Extremism Efforts:** Austria takes a thoughtful approach to combatting extremism, focusing on both the underlying issues and the need for security.
4. **Integration of Older People's Voices:** Austria is known for bringing the voices of older adults into the heart of policy-making.
5. **Digital Age Human Rights:** Austria is all in when it comes to discussing human rights in our digital world.
6. **UNHRC Presidency:** Elisabeth Tichy-Fisslberger from Austria has been elected as the President of the Human Rights Council.
7. **Regional Office Coverage:** Austria is covered by the OHCHR Regional Office for Europe.
8. **Permanent Representation:** Austria has a Permanent Mission to the UN located in Geneva.